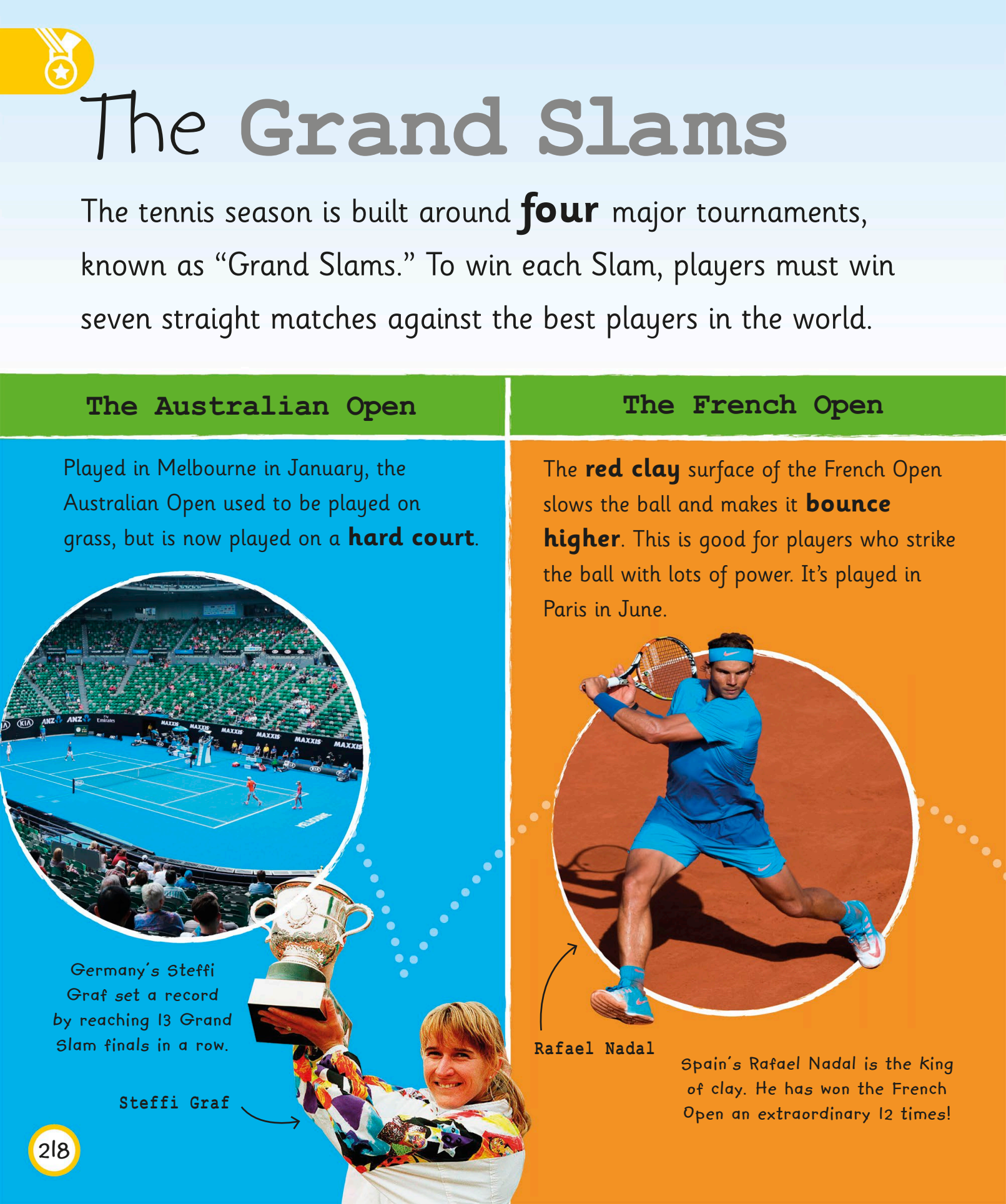




The Grand Slams

The tennis season is built around **four** major tournaments, known as “Grand Slams.” To win each Slam, players must win seven straight matches against the best players in the world.

The Australian Open

Played in Melbourne in January, the Australian Open used to be played on grass, but is now played on a **hard court**.



Germany's Steffi Graf set a record by reaching 13 Grand Slam finals in a row.

Steffi Graf



The French Open

The **red clay** surface of the French Open slows the ball and makes it **bounce higher**. This is good for players who strike the ball with lots of power. It's played in Paris in June.



Rafael Nadal

Spain's Rafael Nadal is the king of clay. He has won the French Open an extraordinary 12 times!